The Way Back Home

Little ones: a 7-week series for ages 3–5



The same story as the 6–10 series, week by week, so brothers and sisters learn the same thing on the same Sunday. Each session is about **30 minutes**, full of moving, touching, singing and colouring.

- **Say it!** One tiny truth a week, with moves.
- **A song** to a tune everyone knows.
- **A colouring sheet** to take home, with the song for parents.
- **The Road Home chart:** a sticker on each stop, every week.
- **The spotty plate** (weeks 4 and 6) and **dot stickers** (weeks 3 and 5).

	THEME	SAY IT!	SONG TUNE	BIBLE WORDS
1	**God made it good!**	God made it all good!	Frère Jacques	Genesis 1:31
2	**Listen to God!**	Listen to God!	London Bridge	Proverbs 30:5
3	**Me too**	We all do wrong. Me too.	Mary Had a Little Lamb	Romans 3:23
4	**It won't wash off**	I can't wash it off!	Here We Go Round the Mulberry Bush	Ephesians 2:8
5	**Jesus is the door**	Jesus is the door!	Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star	John 3:16
6	**Jesus is alive!**	Jesus is alive!	Row, Row, Row Your Boat	Luke 24:6
7	**Welcome home!**	Jesus welcomes me home!	If You're Happy and You Know It	1 John 4:19

Each session (about 30 minutes)

- Hook · 5 min
- Story time with the book · 5 min
- Talk · 5 min
- Play or craft · 10 min
- Sing, sticker, pray · 5 min

Tips for little ones

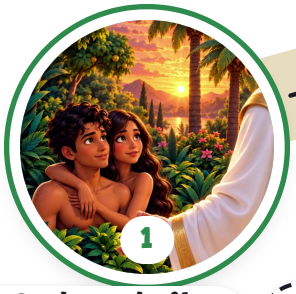
- Keep each part short. Move on before they get wiggly.
- Repeat, repeat, repeat. They love it.
- Use their words: sharing, grumpy, fibs, hugs.
- Speak of sin and of Jesus simply and truly.

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My Road Home

Each week, put a sticker in the circle by that week's picture!

START



God made it good!



Listen to God!



Me too



It won't wash off



Jesus is the door

HOME!



Jesus is alive!



Welcome home!

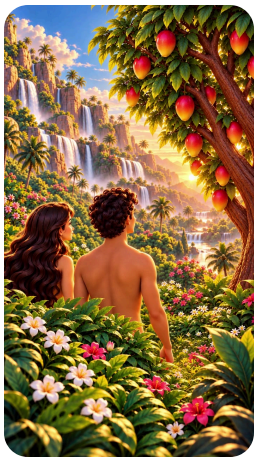
My name: _____

WEEK 1 OF 7 · LITTLE ONES (3–5)

God made it good!

Book pages: **The garden · The one rule**





SAY IT! (WITH THE MOVES)

God made it all good!

Throw your arms wide open on "all", then give a big thumbs up on "good!"

1 · Feely box 5 min

Put a leaf, a flower, a stone and a feather in a box. Children reach in and feel. "What is it? Who made it?" Everyone shouts: "God did!"

2 · Story time 5 min

Sit close. Play this week's pages at **thewaybackhome.net** (tap **Listen**). Pause on each picture: "What do you see?"

3 · Talk 5 min

- Who made the trees? The birds? You?
- God made Adam and Eve a garden home. Was it a happy place?

4 · Stick-a-garden 10 min

Children colour the take-home tree and stick on scrunched tissue paper "leaves". Talk as you go: God made the trees, the flowers, and you!

5 · Sing, sticker, pray 5 min

Sing the song, do the "Say it!" moves, and put a sticker on this week's stop on the Road Home chart. Pray a short thank-you prayer together.

Bible words

"...and it was very good indeed."

Genesis 1:31 (CSB)

Song tune: Frère Jacques

God made flowers, God made flowers,
and the trees, and the trees.
God made all the animals, God made all the animals,
and made me! And made me!

You need

- A screen or phone
- A box with a leaf, flower, stone, feather
- Green tissue paper or leaves
- Glue sticks
- Crayons, colouring sheets

Teacher tip

Short and happy! Three- and four-year-olds learn by doing. Let them touch, stick, sing and shout.

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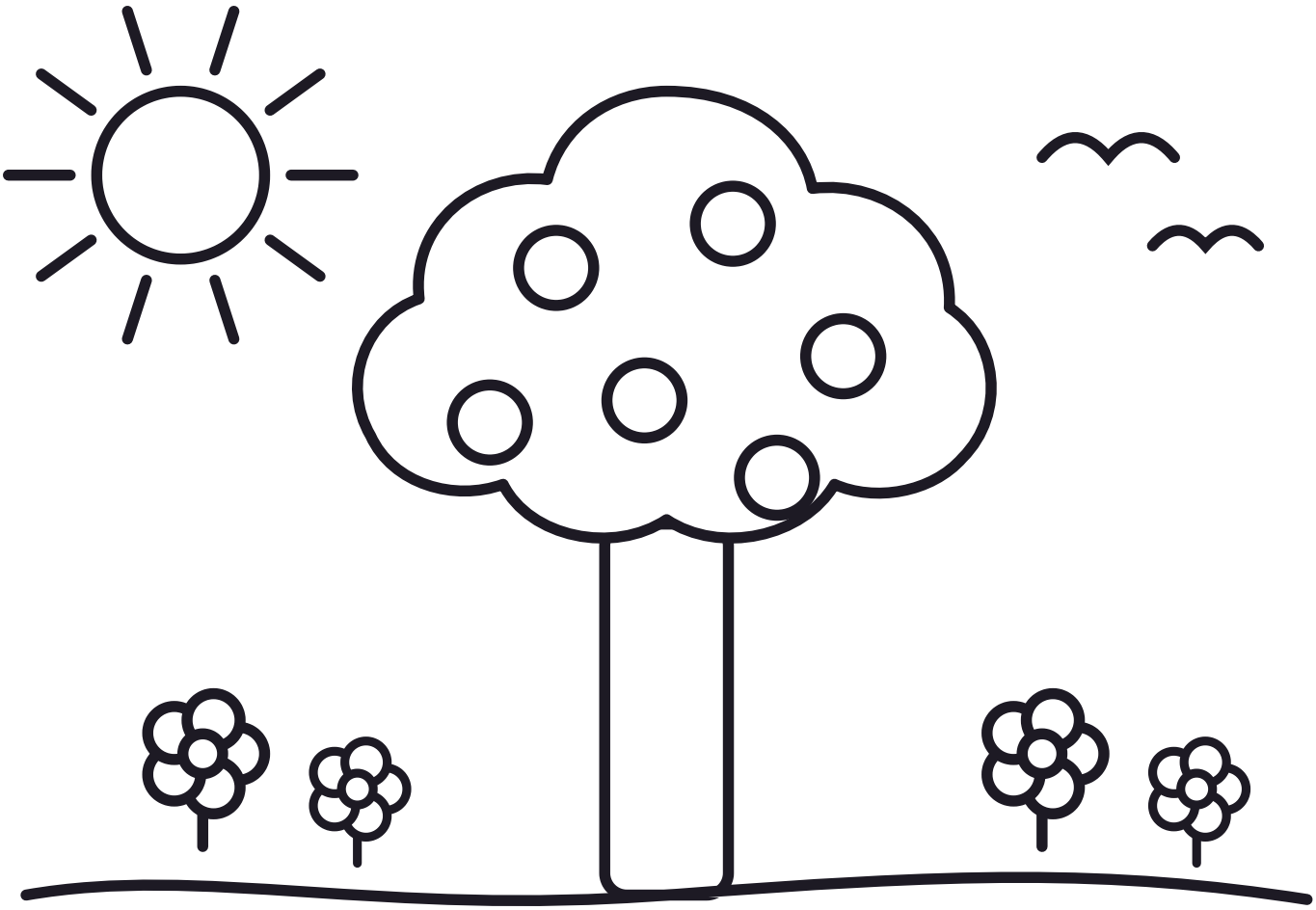


Week 1

God made it good!

“God made it all good!”

Colour God’s good garden. Count the fruit on the tree!



For grown-ups: listen to *The Way Back Home* together at **thewaybackhome.net**. **Ask:** Who made the trees and the flowers? Who made you?

Sing it (tune: Frère Jacques): God made flowers, God made flowers, and the trees, and the trees. God made all the animals, God made all the animals, and made me! And made me!

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WEEK 2 OF 7 · LITTLE ONES (3–5)

Listen to God!

Book pages: **The serpent · The fruit · Out of the garden**





SAY IT! (WITH THE MOVES)

Listen to God!

Cup a hand behind your ear on "Listen", then point up high on "God!"

1 · Sneaky sock snake 5 min

Put a sock snake on your hand. It whispers silly wrong things: "Don't share your toys!" "Eat ALL the cookies!" Children shout back: "No! Listen to God!"

2 · Story time 5 min

Sit close. Play this week's pages at **thewaybackhome.net** (tap **Listen**). Pause on each picture: "What do you see?"

3 · Talk 5 min

- What did the sneaky snake say to Eve?
- Did Adam and Eve listen to God? How did they feel after?

4 · God says, snake says 10 min

Like Simon Says. When you say "God says jump!", everyone jumps. When the sock snake says "Jump!", nobody moves. Anyone who moves just shouts "Listen to God!" and keeps playing.

5 · Sing, sticker, pray 5 min

Sing the song, do the "Say it!" moves, and put a sticker on this week's stop on the Road Home chart. Pray a short thank-you prayer together.

Bible words

"Every word of God is pure…"

Proverbs 30:5 (CSB)

Song tune: London Bridge

Listen, listen, to God's word,
to God's word, to God's word.
Listen, listen, to God's word.
God's word is true!

You need

- A screen or phone
- A sock with two button eyes (a snake puppet)
- The sock snake
- Crayons, colouring sheets

Teacher tip

Keep the snake silly, not scary. The big idea is simple: God tells the truth, so we listen to Him.

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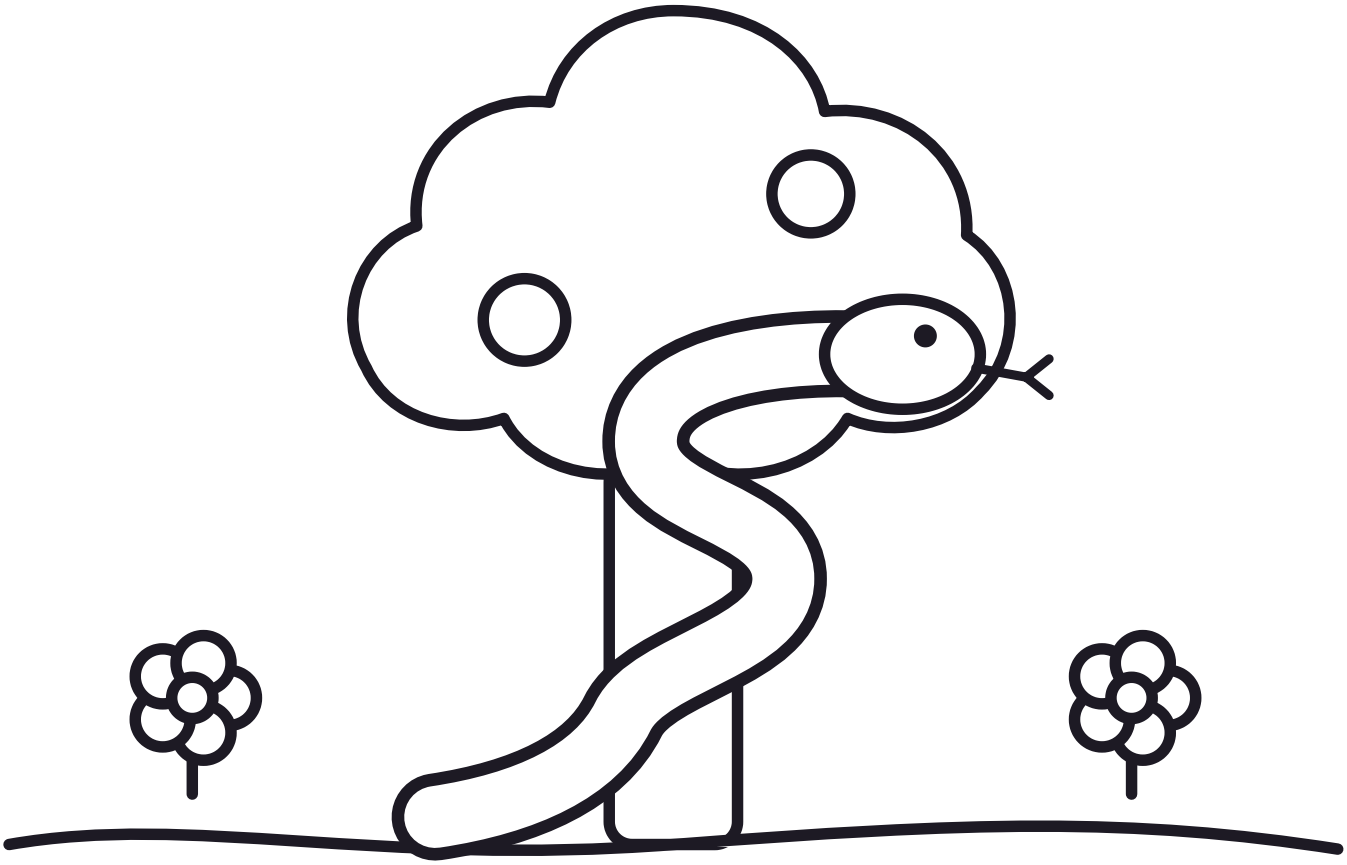


Week 2

Listen to God!

“Listen to God!”

Colour the tree. Can you find the sneaky snake?



For grown-ups: listen to *The Way Back Home* together at **thewaybackhome.net**. **Ask:** What did the snake say? Who do we listen to?

Sing it (tune: London Bridge): Listen, listen, to God’s word, to God’s word, to God’s word. Listen, listen, to God’s word. God’s word is true!

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WEEK 3 OF 7 · LITTLE ONES (3–5)

Me too

Book pages: **The long road** · **God's law**





SAY IT! (WITH THE MOVES)

We all do wrong. Me too.

Point all around on "We all", then point to yourself on "Me too."

1 · Look in the mirror 5 min

Pass a hand mirror around. Each child looks and makes a funny face. Say: "God sees inside us too, our hearts."

2 · Story time 5 min

Sit close. Play this week's pages at **thewaybackhome.net** (tap **Listen**). Pause on each picture: "What do you see?"

3 · Talk 5 min

- Have you ever been grumpy? Not shared? Said something unkind?
- Does everybody do wrong things? Even grown-ups? Yes, me too.

4 · A spot for everyone 10 min

Give every child one dot sticker on the back of their hand: a "wrong spot". Give one to every leader too. Look around: "Does anyone not have a spot?" Everybody has one. Keep the spots on for next week's story.

5 · Sing, sticker, pray 5 min

Sing the song, do the "Say it!" moves, and put a sticker on this week's stop on the Road Home chart. Pray a short thank-you prayer together.

Bible words

"...all have sinned..."

Romans 3:23 (CSB)

Song tune: Mary Had a Little Lamb

Everybody does wrong things,
wrong things, wrong things.
Everybody does wrong things.
Me too, yes, me too.

You need

- A screen or phone
- A hand mirror
- Small round stickers (dots)
- Crayons, colouring sheets

Teacher tip

Use words little ones know: grumpy, not sharing, hitting, telling fibs. Say "me too" about yourself, cheerfully and honestly.

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Week 3

Me too

“We all do wrong. Me too.”

Draw your face in the mirror. God loves you and sees your heart!

For grown-ups: listen to *The Way Back Home* together at **thewaybackhome.net**. **Ask:** Does everybody do wrong things? Do you? Do I?

Sing it (tune: Mary Had a Little Lamb): Everybody does wrong things, wrong things, wrong things. Everybody does wrong things. Me too, yes, me too.

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WEEK 4 OF 7 · LITTLE ONES (3–5)

It won't wash off

Book pages: **Locked out** · **Can we scrub it off?**





SAY IT! (WITH THE MOVES)

I can't wash it off!

Pretend to scrub your hands hard, then stop and shake your head on "can't".

1 · The plate that stays dirty 5 min

Draw a small spot on a white plastic plate with a permanent marker. Let each child scrub it with a wet sponge. It won't come off! Keep the plate for week 6.

2 · Story time 5 min

Sit close. Play this week's pages at **thewaybackhome.net** (tap **Listen**). Pause on each picture: "What do you see?"

3 · Talk 5 min

- The children in the book tried to wash their spots off. Did it work?
- Sin keeps us away from God's home. Who can help us?

4 · Washing game 10 min

Let children "wash" toy dishes in soapy water (messy fun!). Then hold up the marked plate again: "Some spots we can wash. But we can't wash away the wrong things in our hearts. Next week we meet Someone who can help!"

5 · Sing, sticker, pray 5 min

Sing the song, do the "Say it!" moves, and put a sticker on this week's stop on the Road Home chart. Pray a short thank-you prayer together.

Bible words

"...it is God's gift."

Ephesians 2:8 (CSB)

Song tune: Here We Go Round the Mulberry Bush

This is the way we scrub our hands,
scrub our hands, scrub our hands.
This is the way we scrub our hands,
but sin will not wash away!

You need

- A screen or phone
- A white plastic plate
- A permanent marker
- A bowl of water and a sponge
- A tub of soapy water, toy dishes, towels
- Crayons, colouring sheets

Teacher tip

The book says sin locks us out of God's home. Say it gently and simply, and end hopeful: "But God has a plan!"

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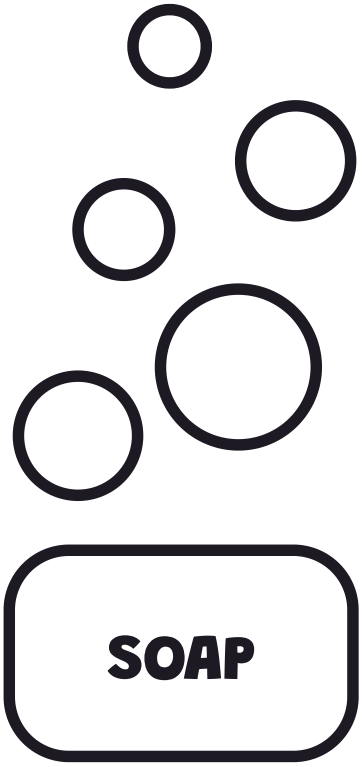
Week 4

It won't wash off

"I can't wash it off!"

Trace your hand. Draw spots on it. Can soap wash away sin? No! Only Jesus can.

Trace your hand here



For grown-ups: listen to *The Way Back Home* together at **thewaybackhome.net**. **Ask:** Can we wash the wrong things in our hearts away by ourselves?

Sing it (tune: Here We Go Round the Mulberry Bush): This is the way we scrub our hands, scrub our hands, scrub our hands. This is the way we scrub our hands, but sin will not wash away!

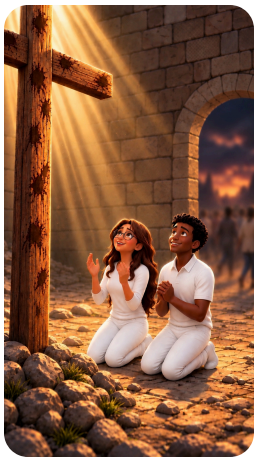
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WEEK 5 OF 7 · LITTLE ONES (3–5)

Jesus is the door

Book pages: **The door** · **The cross**





SAY IT! (WITH THE MOVES)

Jesus is the door!

Make a door with your arms, then swing them wide open on "door!"

1 · Knock knock! 5 min

Stand behind a closed door (or a blanket held up). Children knock: "Knock, knock!" Open it wide with a big smile and welcome each child through. "Jesus said, 'I am the door.' He opens the way to God!"

2 · Story time 5 min

Sit close. Play this week's pages at **thewaybackhome.net** (tap **Listen**). Pause on each picture: "What do you see?"

3 · Talk 5 min

- Who is the door to God's home?
- Jesus died on the cross because He loves us. How much does Jesus love you? (Arms out wide: THIS much!)

4 · Through the door 10 min

Two leaders hold hands up high to make a doorway. Children walk or crawl through to a "home" blanket where a leader gives them a high five. Each time, shout: "Jesus is the door!" Then peel off last week's dot stickers: "Jesus takes our wrong things away!"

5 · Sing, sticker, pray 5 min

Sing the song, do the "Say it!" moves, and put a sticker on this week's stop on the Road Home chart. Pray a short thank-you prayer together.

Bible words

"God loved the world…"

John 3:16 (CSB)

Song tune: Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star

Jesus is the door for me,
on the cross He died for me.
In my place He took my sin,
now the door says, "Come on in!"

You need

- A screen or phone
- A door or a blanket to hold up
- Two leaders, or a big cardboard box with a door cut in it
- Crayons, colouring sheets

Teacher tip

Keep the cross simple and full of love: "Jesus died for me because He loves me." Little ones understand love before they understand ideas.

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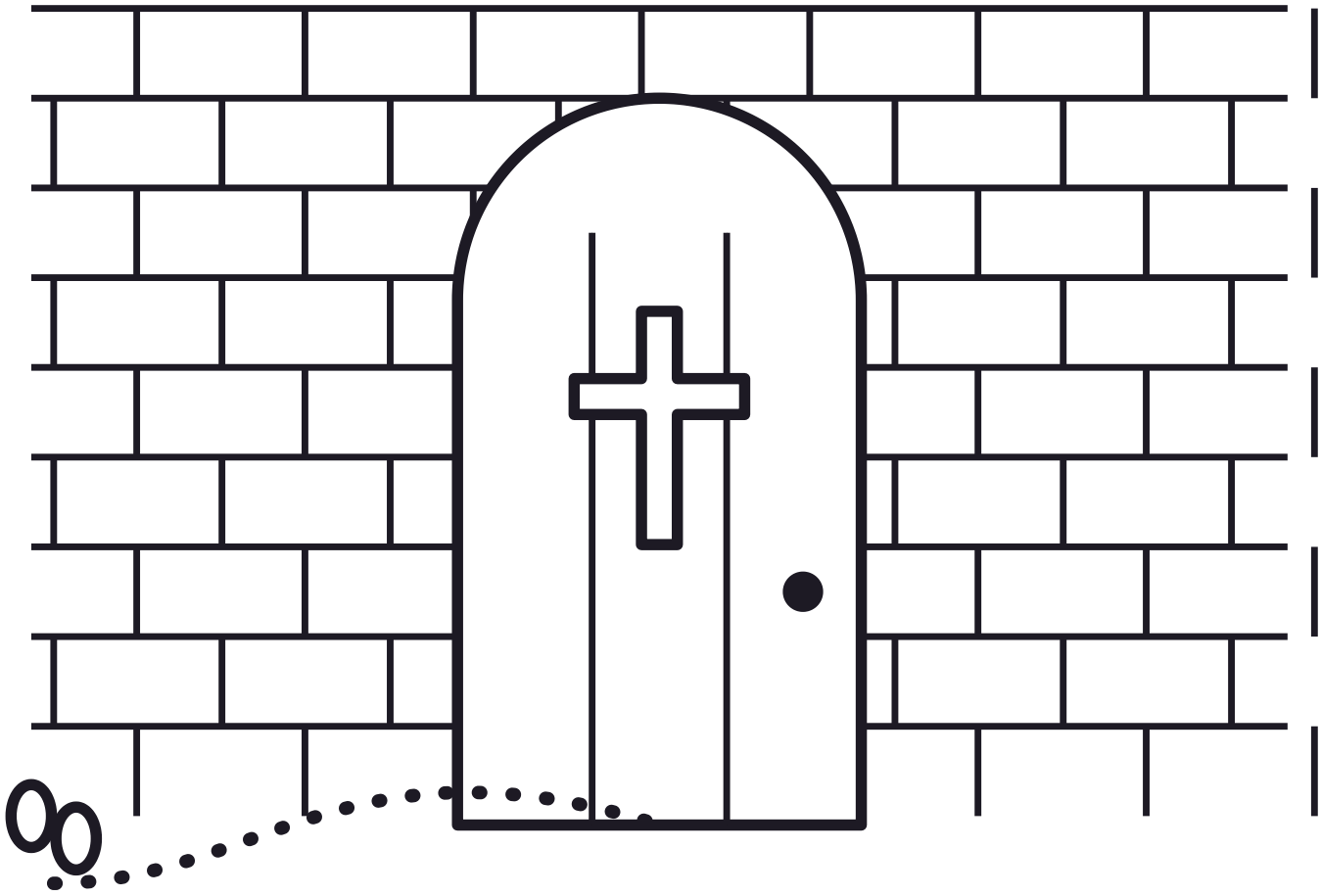


Week 5

Jesus is the door

“Jesus is the door!”

Colour the door with the cross. Follow the dotted footsteps to the door!



For grown-ups: listen to *The Way Back Home* together at **thewaybackhome.net**. **Ask:** Who is the door? How much does Jesus love you?

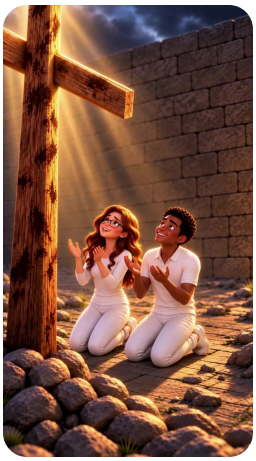
Sing it (tune: Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star): Jesus is the door for me, on the cross He died for me. In my place He took my sin, now the door says, “Come on in!”

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WEEK 6 OF 7 · LITTLE ONES (3–5)

Jesus is alive!

Book pages: **The choice** · **The empty tomb**





SAY IT! (WITH THE MOVES)

Jesus is alive!

Crouch down low, then jump up high with your arms in the air on "alive!"

1 · The empty box 5 min

Show a box with a paper-plate "stone" on it. "Jesus' friends came to His tomb…" Roll the stone away slowly. Empty! "He is not here! He is alive!"

2 · Story time 5 min

Sit close. Play this week's pages at **thewaybackhome.net** (tap **Listen**). Pause on each picture: "What do you see?"

3 · Talk 5 min

- Was Jesus still in the tomb? Where was He?
- Bring out the spotty plate, wipe it with cleaner, and the spot is gone! "Jesus makes us clean!"

4 · Sleepy, sleepy… ALIVE! 10 min

Everyone lies down very still and sleepy. Whisper: "Shhh…" Then shout "Jesus is ALIVE!" and everyone jumps up cheering. Play it again and again. They will want to!

5 · Sing, sticker, pray 5 min

Sing the song, do the "Say it!" moves, and put a sticker on this week's stop on the Road Home chart. Pray a short thank-you prayer together.

Bible words

"He is not here, but he has risen!"

Luke 24:6 (CSB)

Song tune: Row, Row, Row Your Boat

Up, up, up He rose,
Jesus is alive!
Happily, happily, happily, happily,
Jesus is alive!

You need

- A screen or phone
- A box with a paper-plate "stone"
- The marked plate and rubbing alcohol (try it at home first)
- Crayons, colouring sheets

Teacher tip

This is a party week! Big voices, big jumps, big smiles.

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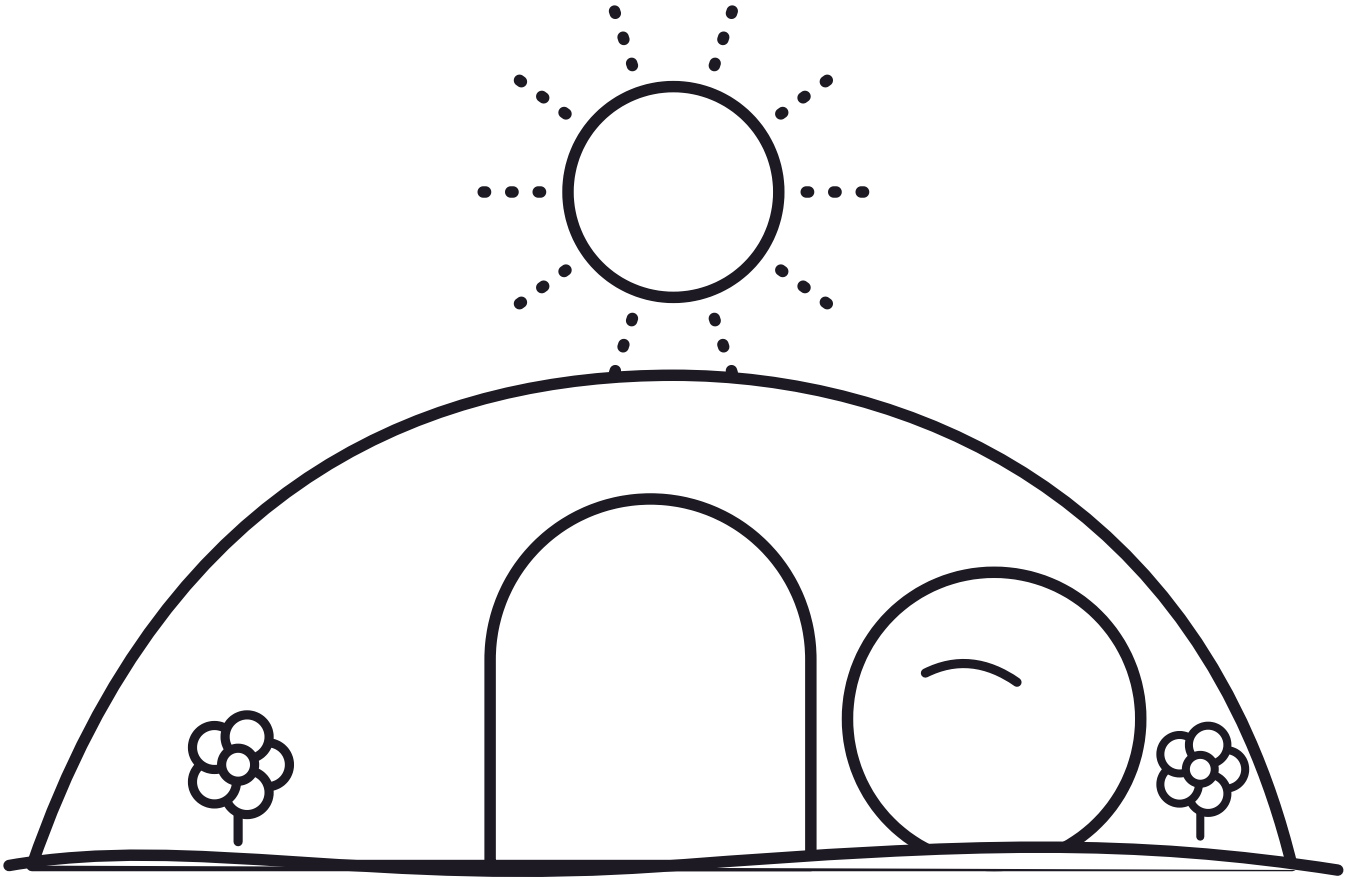


Week 6

Jesus is alive!

“Jesus is alive!”

Colour the empty tomb and the stone. Trace the sun’s dotted rays!



For grown-ups: listen to *The Way Back Home* together at **thewaybackhome.net**. **Ask:** Where is Jesus now? Is He alive?

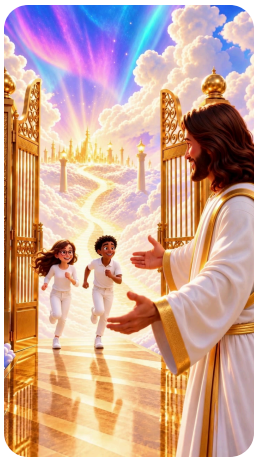
Sing it (tune: Row, Row, Row Your Boat): Up, up, up He rose, Jesus is alive! Happily, happily, happily, happily, Jesus is alive!

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WEEK 7 OF 7 · LITTLE ONES (3–5)

Welcome home!

Book pages: **Heaven's gates · The new earth · Follow Jesus**





SAY IT! (WITH THE MOVES)

Jesus welcomes me home!

Open your arms wide, then give yourself a big hug on "home!"

1 · Welcome-home party 5 min

Leaders make a high-five tunnel at the door and cheer each child in by name: "Welcome home!" Add bubbles if you can!

2 · Story time 5 min

Sit close. Play this week's pages at **thewaybackhome.net** (tap **Listen**). Pause on each picture: "What do you see?"

3 · Talk 5 min

- Who is waiting at heaven's gates with open arms?
- Jesus loves you so much! Would you like to tell Him so in a little prayer?

4 · Hug-and-pray 10 min

Sit close. Pray a line at a time; children who want to can say it after you: "Dear Jesus, I'm sorry for the wrong things I do. Thank You for loving me. Please be my friend forever. Amen." Then add the last sticker to the chart!

5 · Sing, sticker, pray 5 min

Sing the song, do the "Say it!" moves, and put a sticker on this week's stop on the Road Home chart. Pray a short thank-you prayer together.

Bible words

"We love because he first loved us."

1 John 4:19 (CSB)

Song tune: If You're Happy and You Know It

Jesus loves me and He wants me, clap your hands! (sing it twice)
He will welcome me back home, I'm His child, I'm His own.
Jesus loves me and He wants me, clap your hands!

You need

- A screen or phone
- Bubbles or streamers
- Stickers for the Road Home charts
- Crayons, colouring sheets

Teacher tip

Never pressure a little one to pray. Just invite, and tell parents what was prayed.

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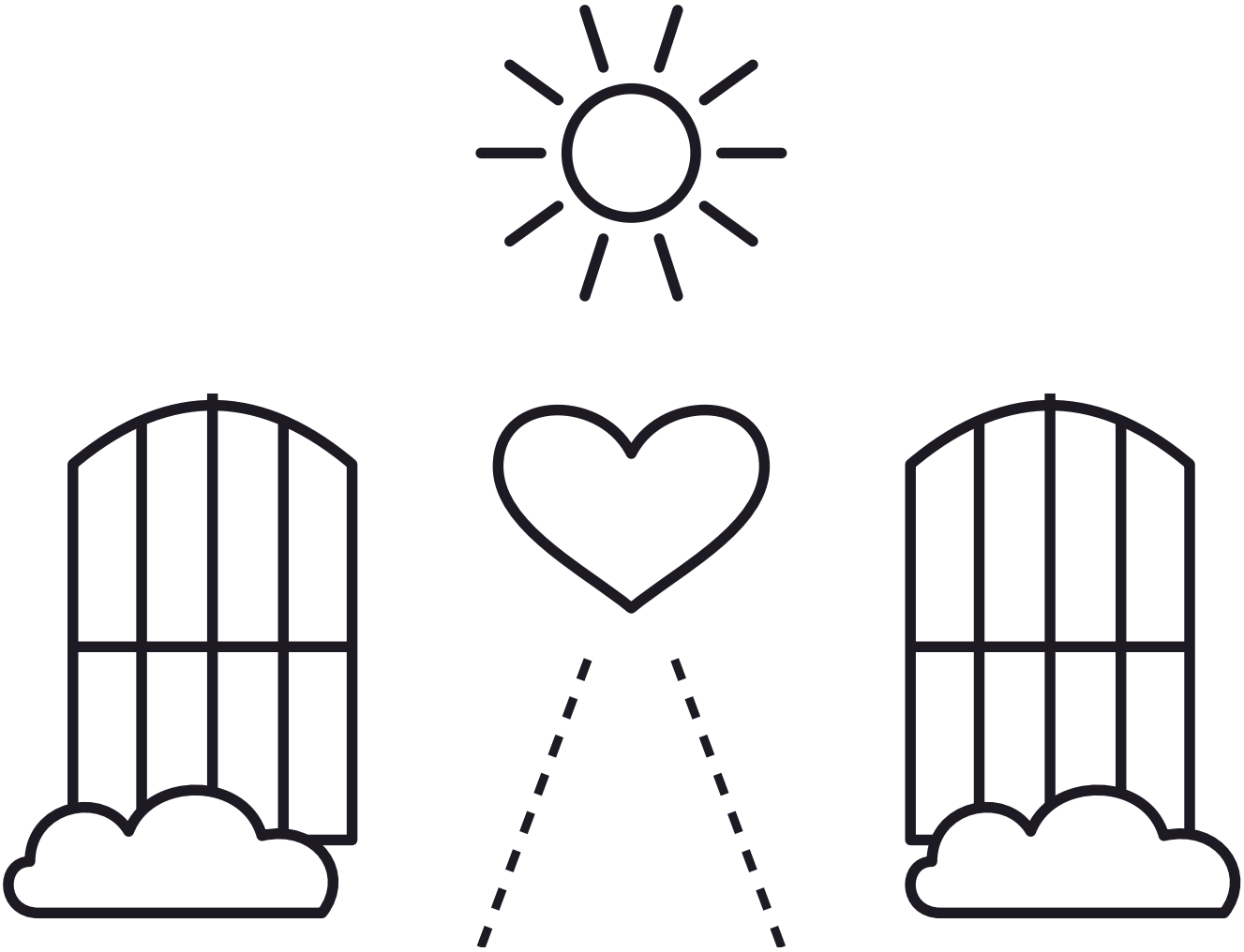


Week 7

Welcome home!

“Jesus welcomes me home!”

Colour heaven’s open gates. Draw yourself running home to Jesus!



For grown-ups: listen to *The Way Back Home* together at **thewaybackhome.net**. **Ask:** Who welcomes us home? Who loves you more than anyone?

Sing it (tune: If You’re Happy and You Know It): Jesus loves me and He wants me, clap your hands! (sing it twice) He will welcome me back home, I’m His child, I’m His own. Jesus loves me and He wants me, clap your hands!

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WELL DONE!

I heard The Way Back Home!



Jesus loves

“We love because he first loved us.” 1 John 4:19

Teacher _____ Date _____

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